Together, we flourish.

Community Foundation™

for the Fox Valley Region

Northeast Wisconsin Nonprofit Survey

In collaboration with:

Basic Needs Giving Partnership

Brown County United Way | 1925 in 2025 100 Years

Together, we flourish. Community Foundation™ for the Fox Valley Region

Nonprofit Leadership Initiative

Greater Green Bay Community Foundation — good grows here™

Shawano Area United Way

United Way Fox Cities

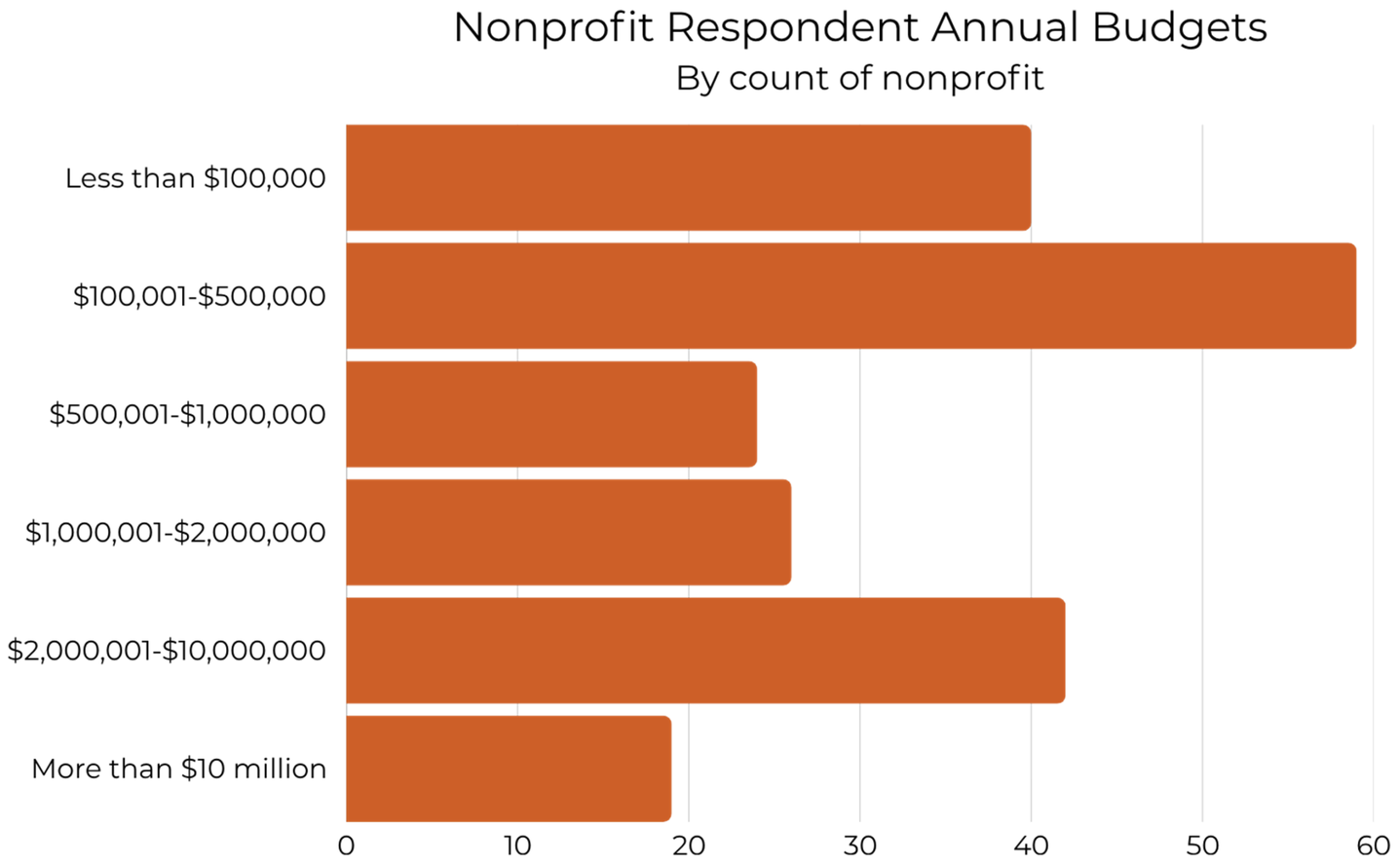
Survey Origination

- **Greater Milwaukee Foundation** and **Madison Community Foundation** surveyed their respective nonprofit grantees earlier in 2025; this survey adapted their questions to fit our needs and community
- The seven partners on the previous slide sent the same survey link to their respective nonprofit contact lists
- The survey was open from September 26-October 3
- Nonprofits were asked to submit only once per organization
- **210 total responses**

Survey Questions

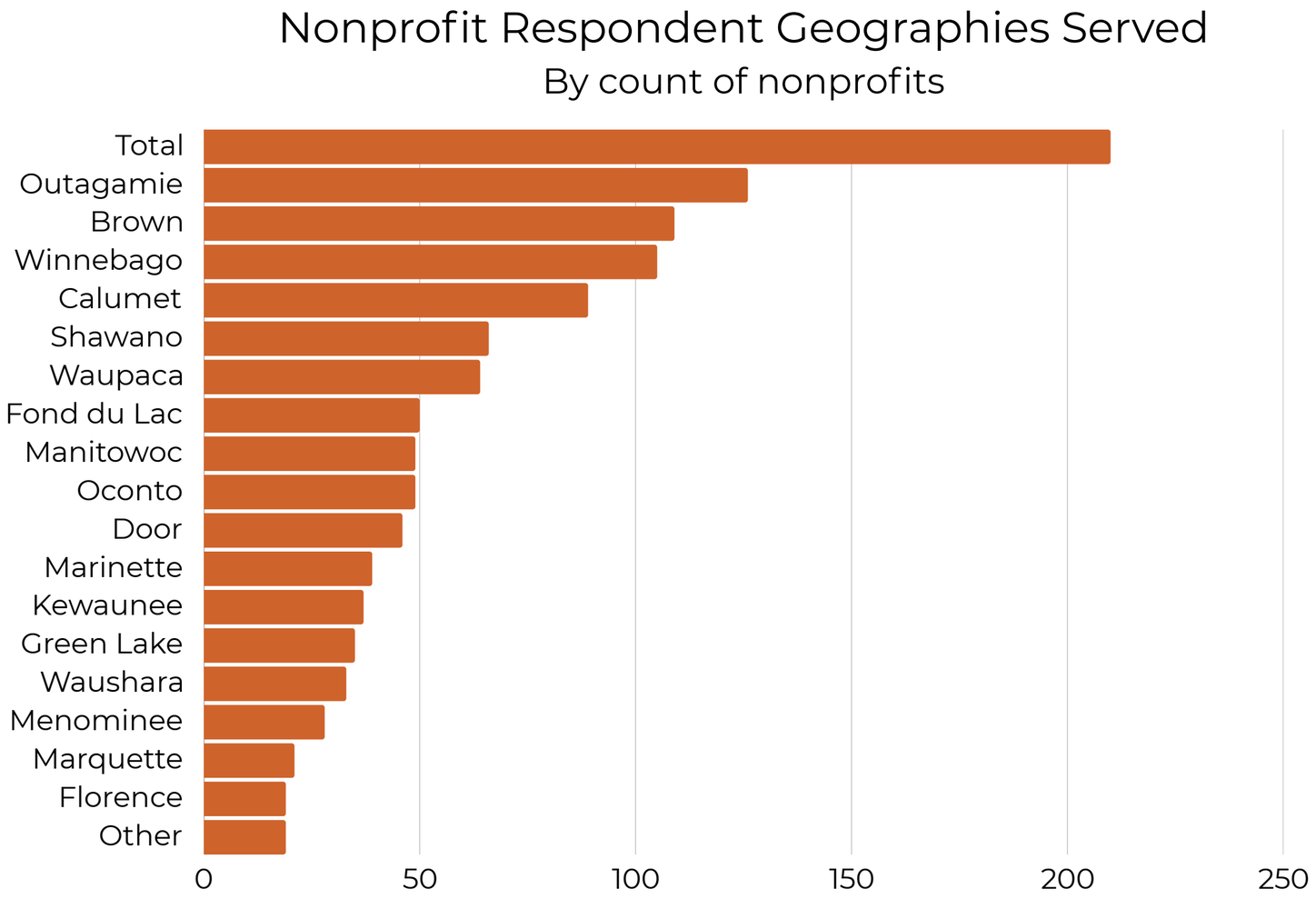
- Respondents were asked:
  - Demographic questions about their nonprofit organization (budget service region, focus areas)
  - About the funding changes they have experienced and how that has impacted their organization
  - About the challenges their organization is currently facing
  - How their organization is adapting to the above challenges
  - Which supports would be most valuable to their organization
- Organizations could opt in to provide the name of their organization and contact information, but this was not required

Survey Respondent Budgets

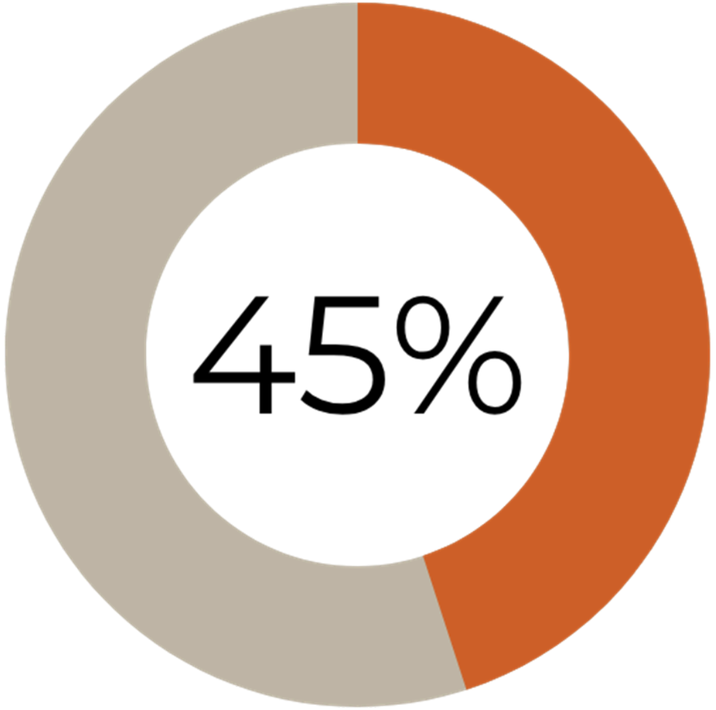


Out of 210 total survey responses

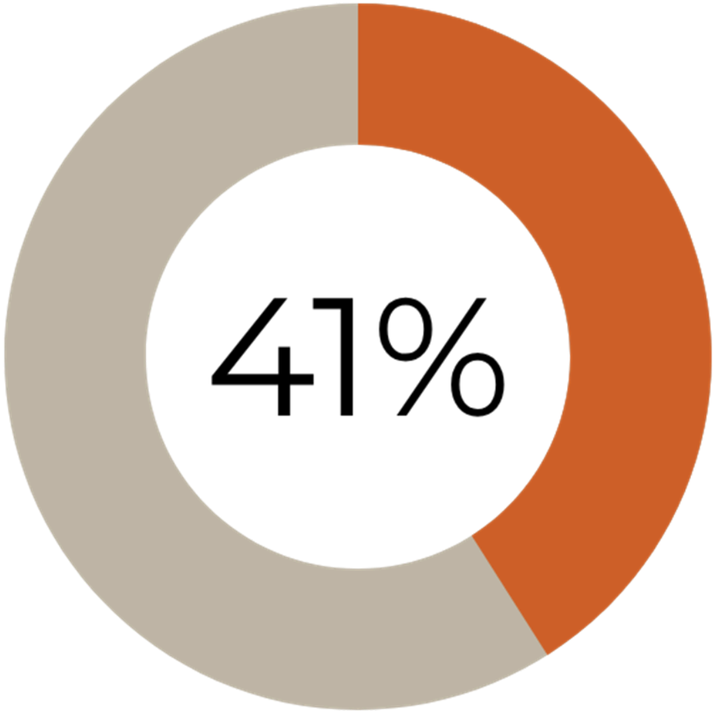
Survey Respondent Geographies Served



Nonprofits Hit Hard By Funding Loss



45% of nonprofit respondents have experienced a **reduction in individual donations**



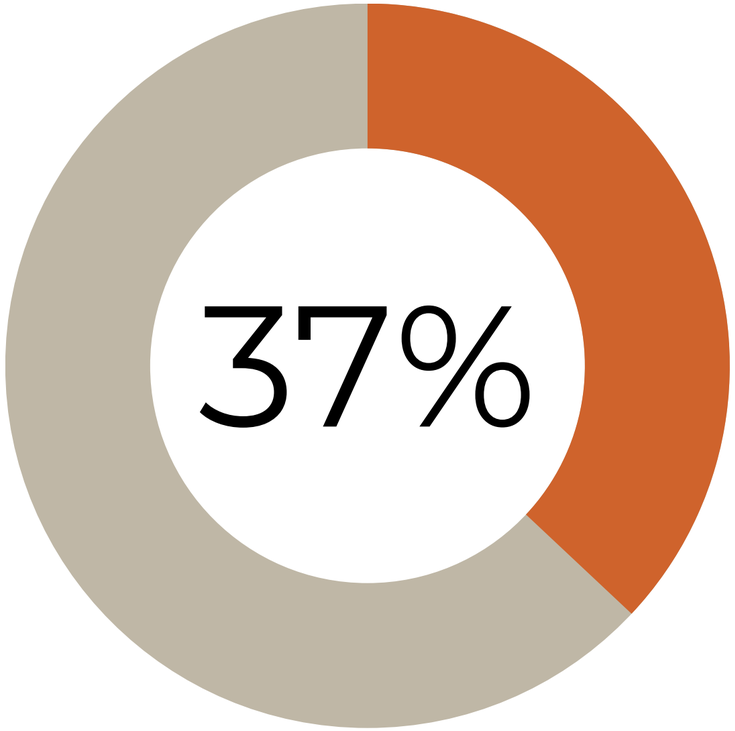
41% of nonprofit respondents have experienced a **reduction in local foundation gifts/grants**

Nonprofits Hit Hard By Funding Loss

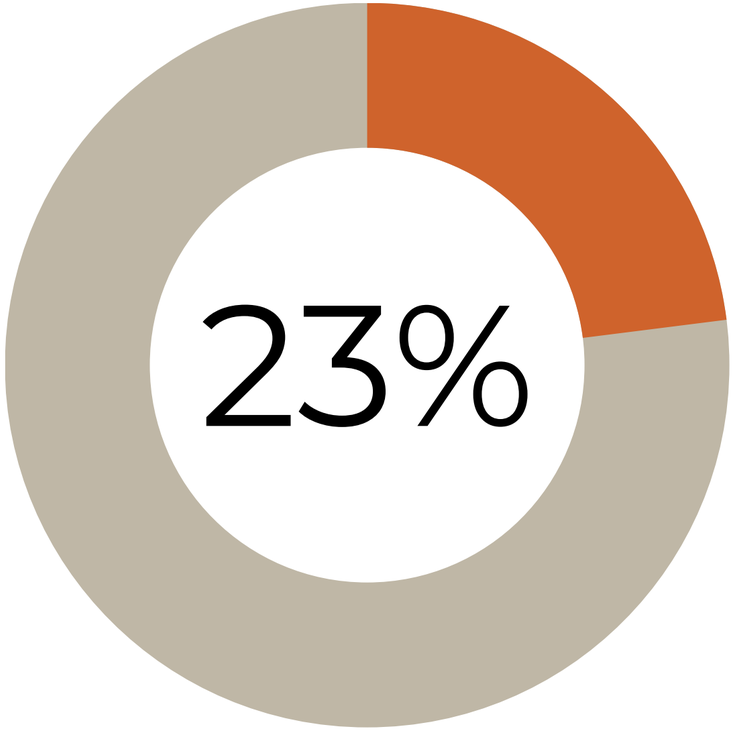
> Our concern is that the support we have received in the past from individuals, corporations & foundations may be redirected to other nonprofit organizations whose services are interpreted as more essential to community success than the services we provide...

> We typically seek grants to help cover the costs for bringing on new staff. A lack of small grants with fast turn around times has been hindering us from growing.

Nonprofits Hit Hard By Funding Loss



37% of nonprofit respondents have experienced a **reduction in corporate gifts/sponsorships**



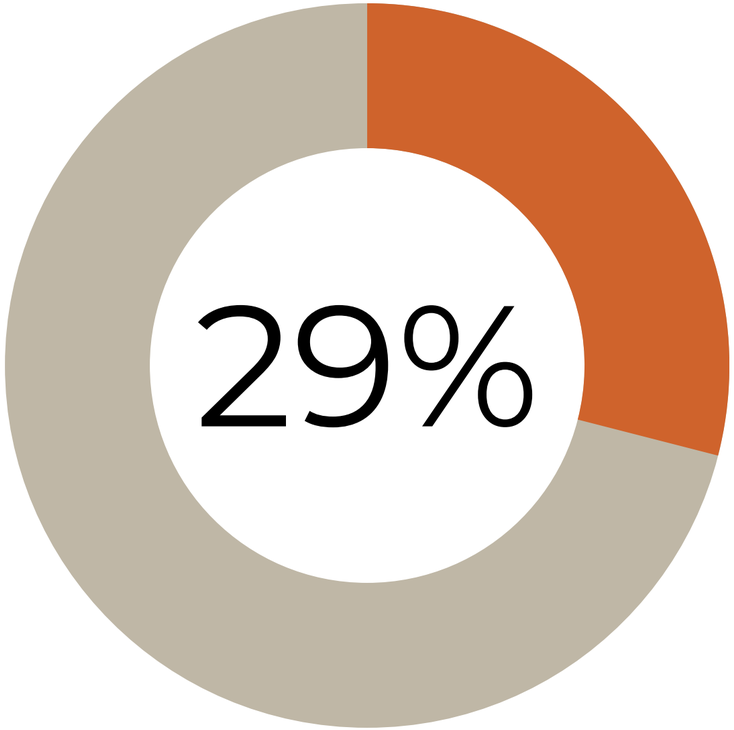
23% of nonprofit respondents have experienced a **reduction in national/state foundation gifts/grants**

Nonprofits Hit Hard By Funding Loss

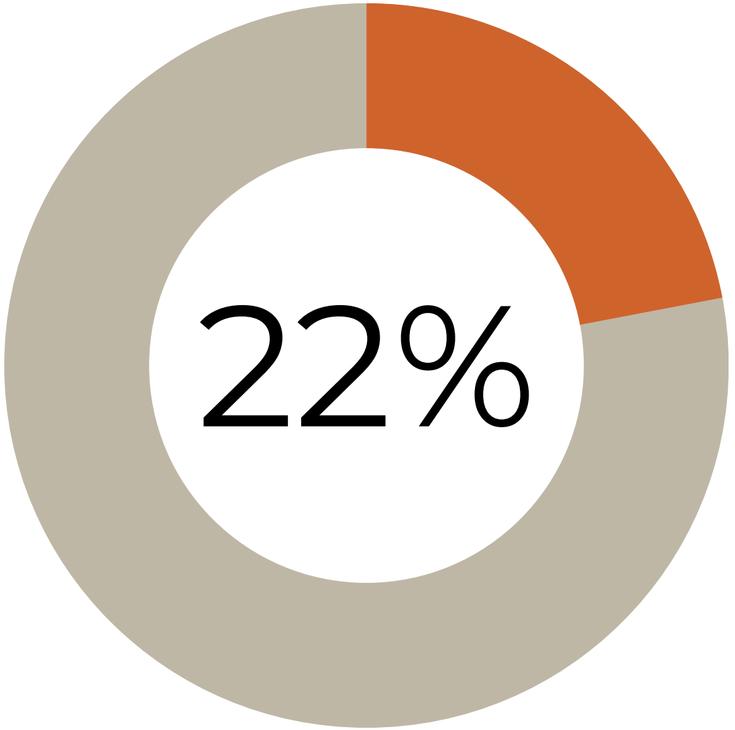
> We are seeing corporations become increasingly selective in their giving--narrowing giving areas and prioritizing nonprofits that have board or volunteer representation. This puts us in a position where we have to chase corporate representation over skillsets which is, again, tough on smaller nonprofits.

> Corporate sponsors remain transactional, "what do I get for giving you $x?" We need to collectively shift them to mission support, not what they get. We also need to communicate the realities that their volunteer days are flops because no one but leadership wants people to volunteer.

Nonprofits Hit Hard By Funding Loss



29% of nonprofit respondents have experienced a **reduction in national/state foundation gifts/grants**



22% of nonprofit respondents have experienced a **freeze/delay in government funding**

Nonprofits Hit Hard By Funding Loss

> [We] have experienced significant impacts since the pandemic, which resulted in loss of funding, loss of staff, loss of resources etc. … funds went away after the pandemic and it has been difficult for the organization to recovery from these losses of resources.

> We do not receive government funding, however, those who do now depend more on the same funding sources we use, potentially making it more difficult to receive funding at the same level as previously experienced… The funding landscape is definitely changing.

Impact of Funding Declines on Nonprofits

Staffing and program cuts

> The impact has been devastating, reducing our staff from 9 to 4.

Struggles with long-term planning

> ...there is significant uncertainty resulting from both the political environment and future funding environment, changes that won't be experienced into 2026 and beyond

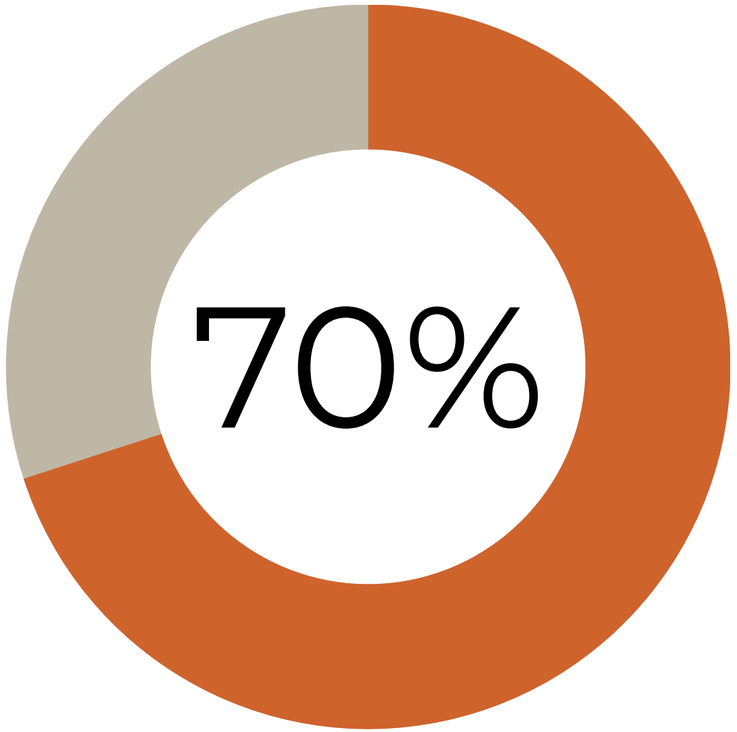
Increased reliance on reserves

> We see our financial reserves being used...

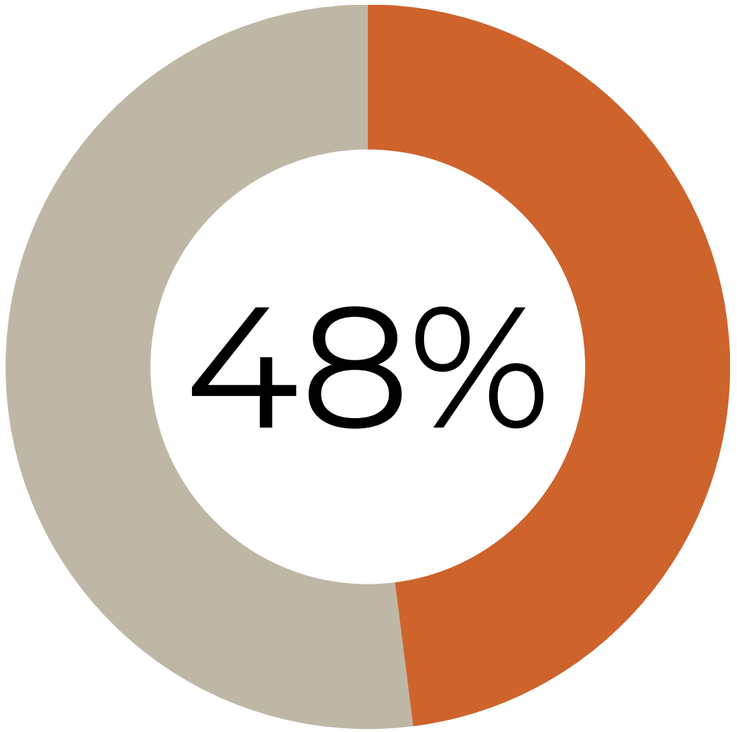
Increased fees

> These reductions have placed a financial strain...causing us to try to fill the gap through program/admission fees

Increased Strain on Nonprofits

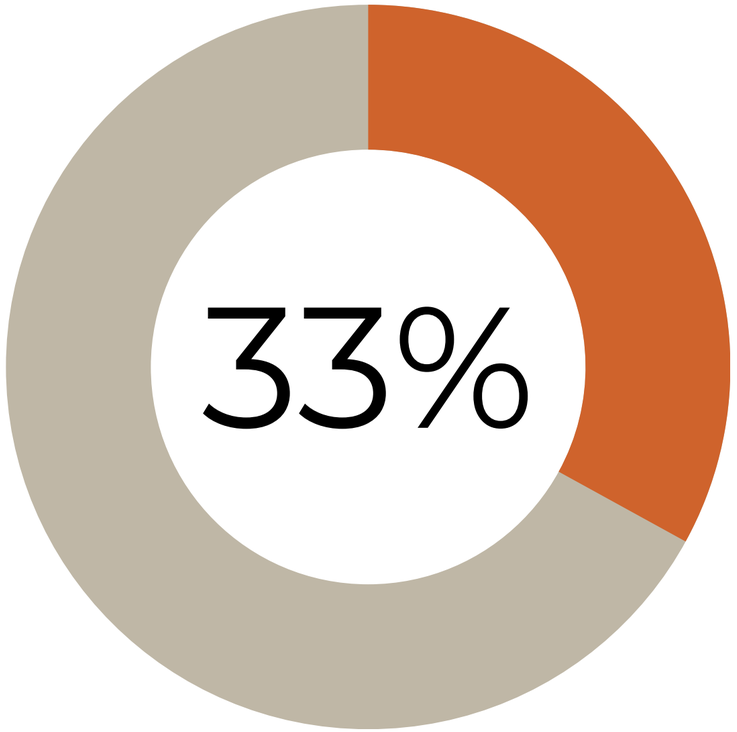


70% of nonprofit respondents said they were currently facing **an increase in community needs/demand for services**

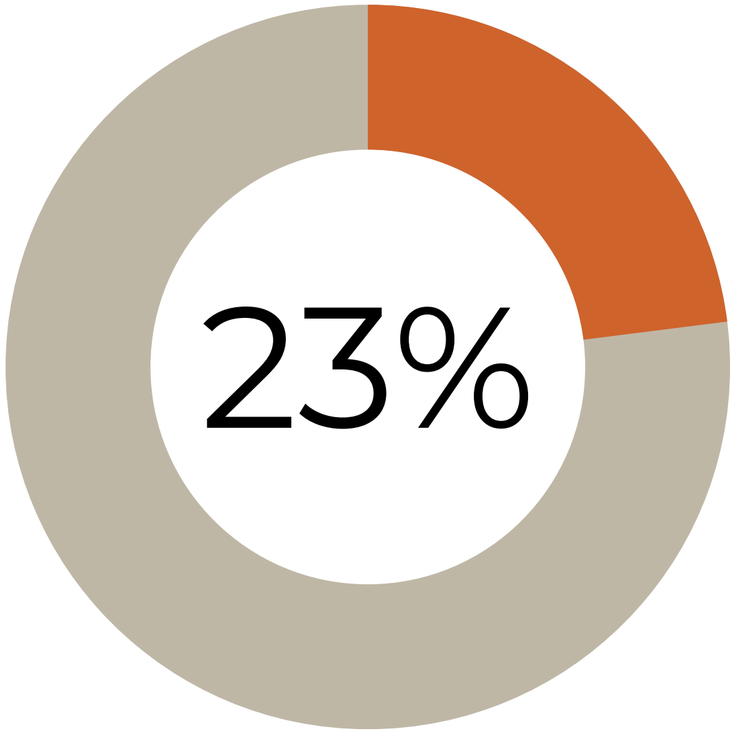


48% of nonprofit respondents said they were currently facing **difficulty meeting operational costs**

Increased Strain on Nonprofits



33% of nonprofit respondents said they were currently facing **staff recruitment challenges**



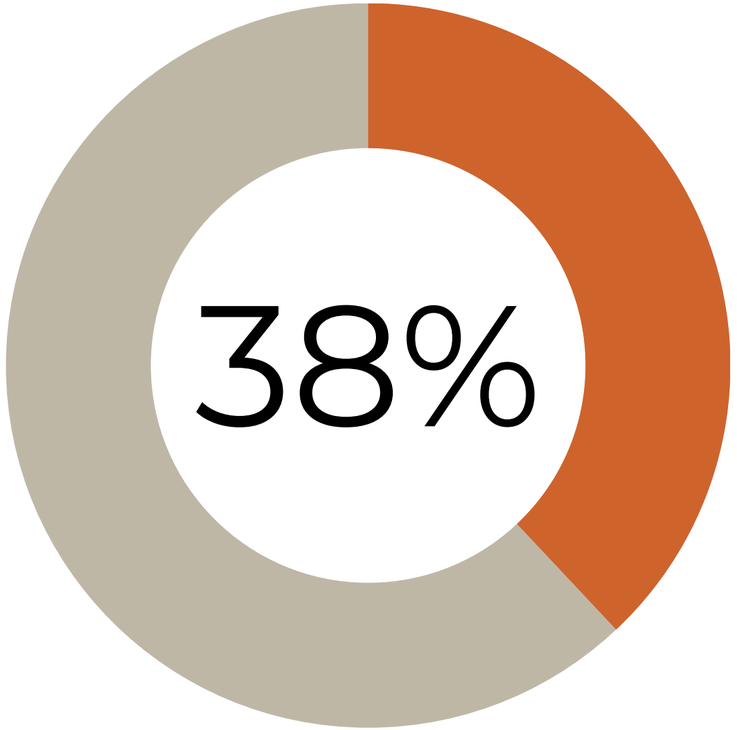
23% of nonprofit respondents said they were currently facing **having to reduce staff time or make staff cuts**

Increased Strain on Nonprofits

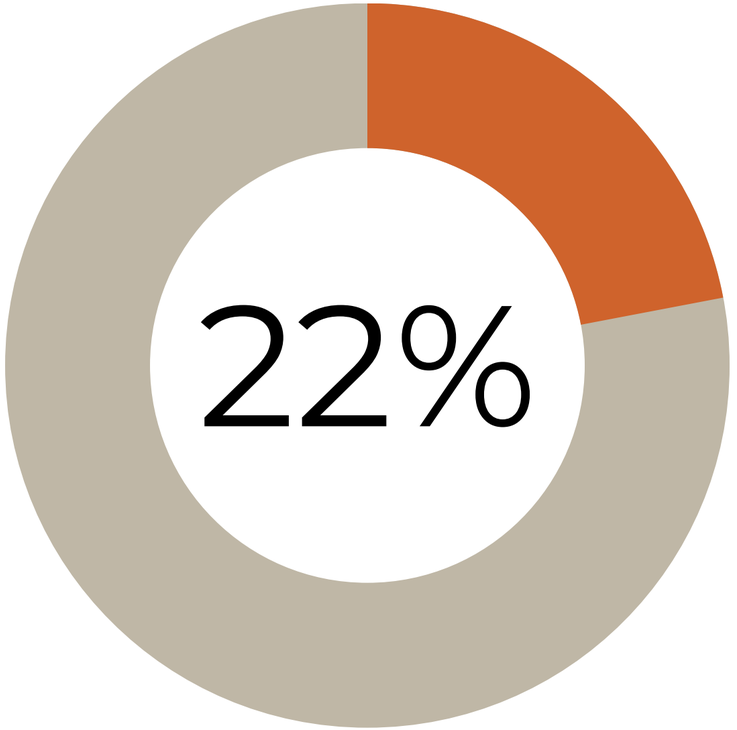
> Reduced funding has impacted staffing levels in an already difficult time when hiring and retaining staff is a challenge. It's also impacted services provided resulting in fewer individuals receiving services they need causing stress on other agencies, if able, to provide support and financial stress on families.

> We had 9 Senior Employment staff [whose] federal funding was cut ... they quickly went from employed support to [needing our support]

Increased Strain on Nonprofits



38% of nonprofit respondents said they were currently facing **volunteer recruitment/retention challenges**



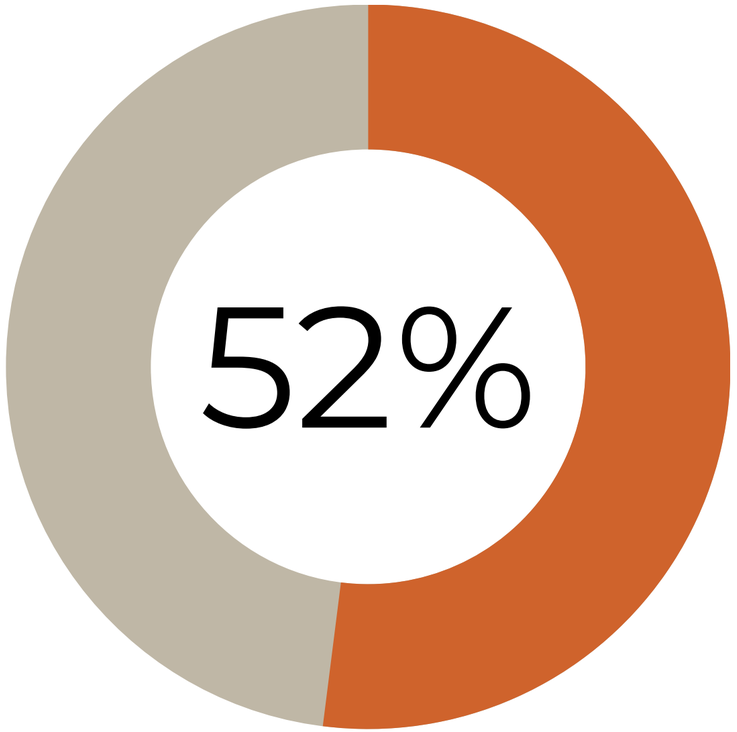
22% of nonprofit respondents said they were currently facing **lower staff morale**

Increased Strain on Nonprofits

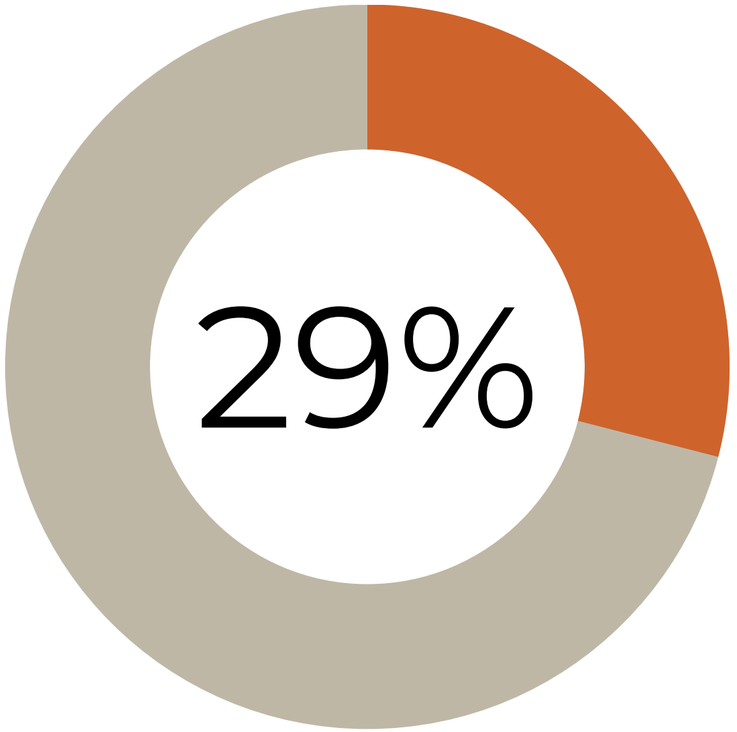
> We are currently an all-volunteer council. We realize now we very much need to transition to a paid position as coordinator but are having difficulty finding a sponsor for the financial support of the role. It is not good for one's health, and one's family, to be volunteering full-time. We need a salaried position.

> With higher operations costs, funding is simply harder to find. We are preparing to drop staff pay and move them back to unpaid work which will lead to limiting /cut programing and services.

Missions Under Scrutiny



52% of nonprofit respondents said they were currently facing **lack of public awareness about their work**



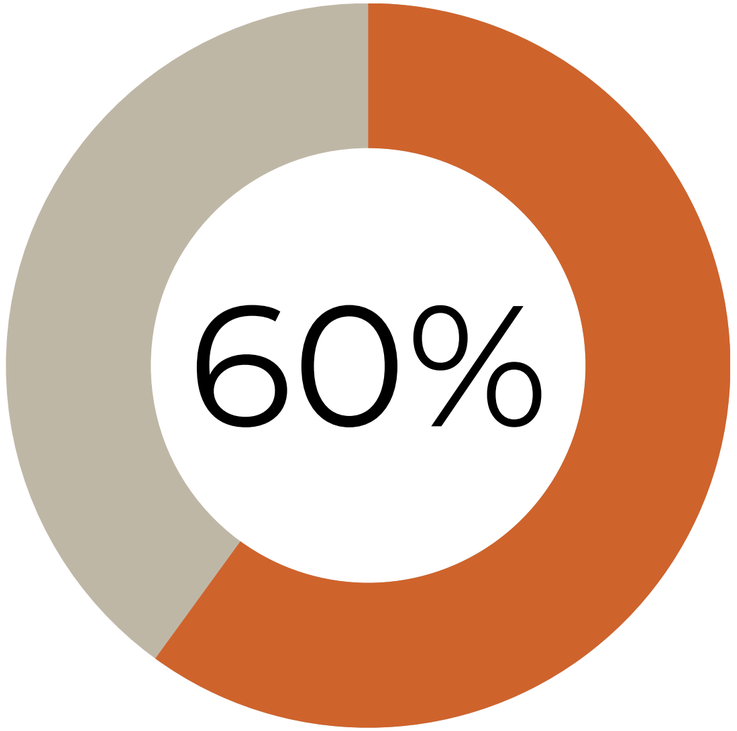
29% of nonprofit respondents said **policy changes were affecting the services they are able to provide**

Missions Under Scrutiny

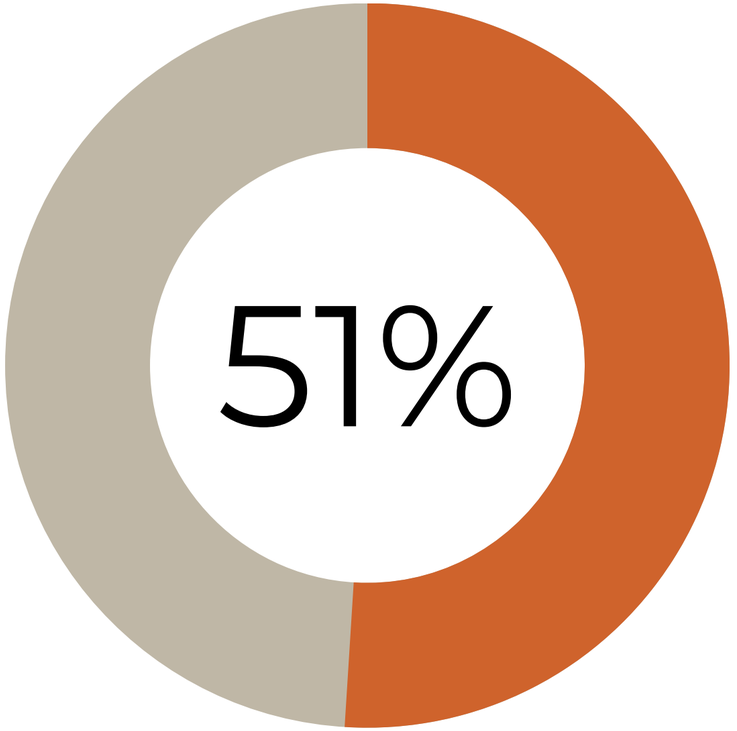
> With looming changes to Medicaid, this will impact many people's ability to access residential care and adult day services will be needed more than ever... families may have to make difficult decisions about quitting jobs to take care of their loved ones.

> We are effective in meeting our mission. I only hope that any fears caused by the news/media about the service we offer were eliminated.

Resiliency in Action: Reimagining

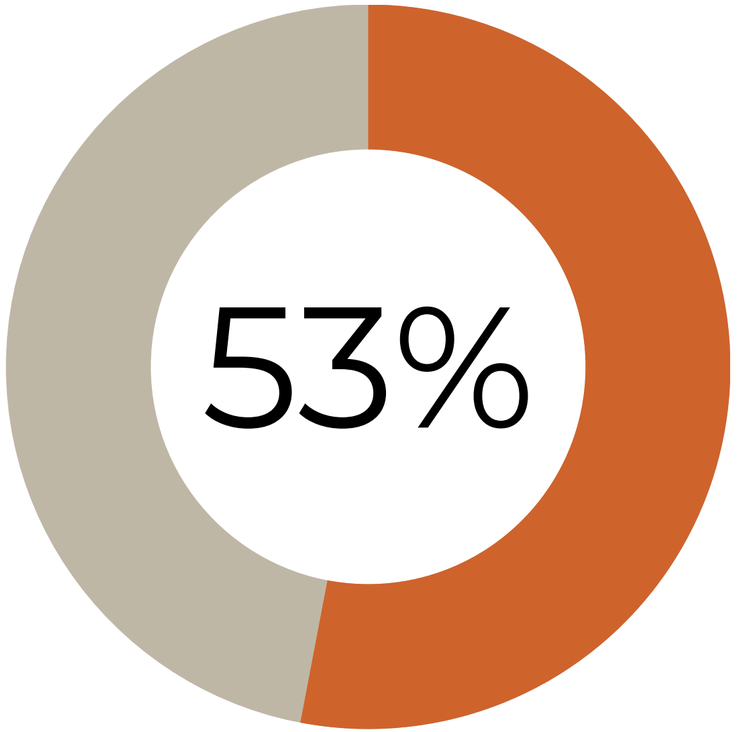


60% of nonprofit respondents said they are **diversifying funding sources**

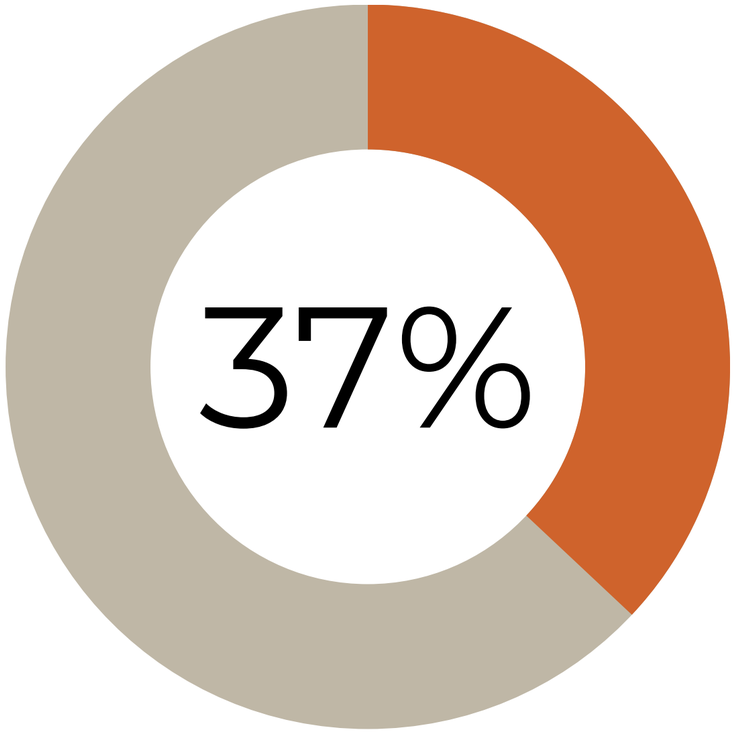


51% of nonprofit respondents said they are **reimagining strategic priorities**

Resiliency in Action: Strengthening

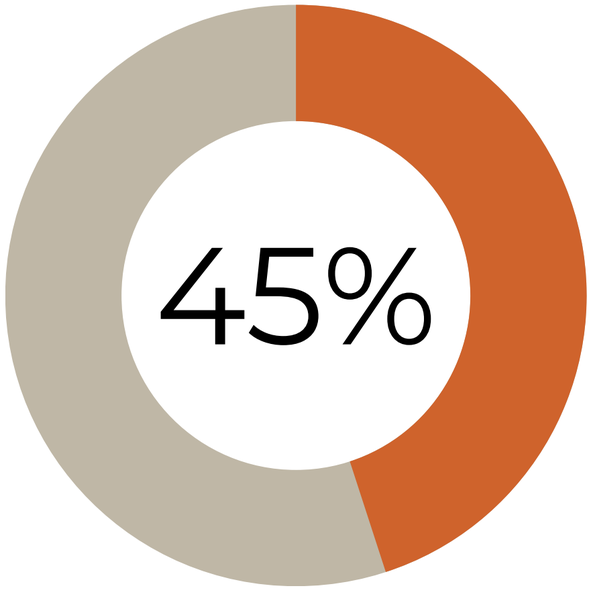


53% of nonprofit respondents said they are **increasing collaboration with other nonprofits**

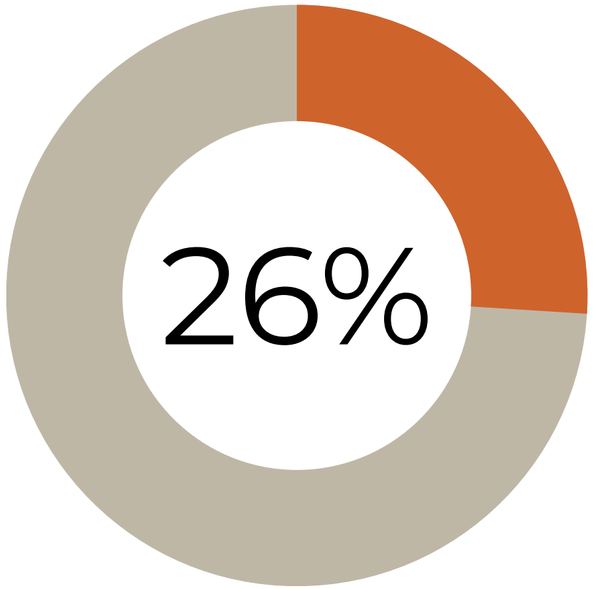


37% of nonprofit respondents said they are **strengthening advocacy and policy efforts**

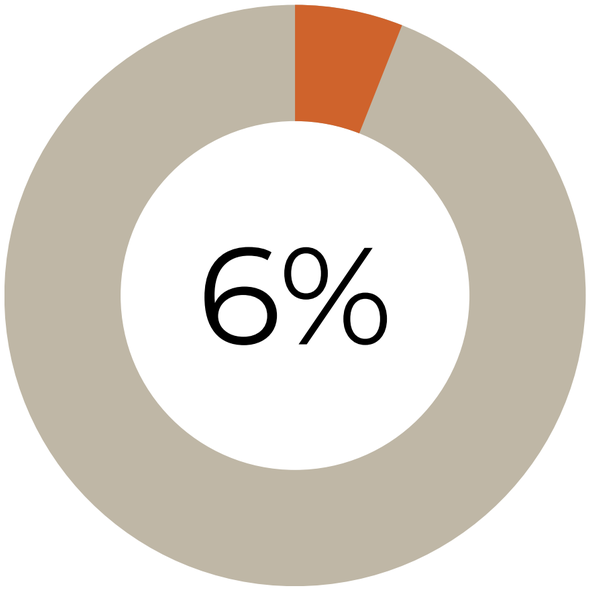
Resiliency in Action: Clarifying



45% of nonprofit respondents said they are **adjusting staffing models**



26% of nonprofit respondents said they are **reducing program supports/services**



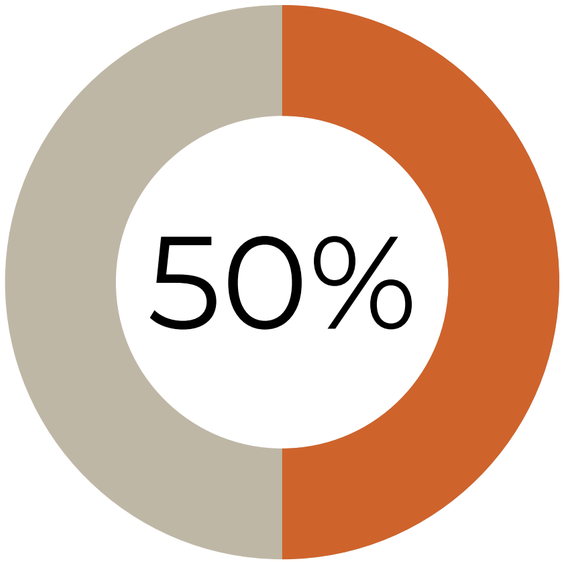
6% of nonprofit respondents said they are **transitioning clients/participants to other nonprofits**

Most Valuable Supports

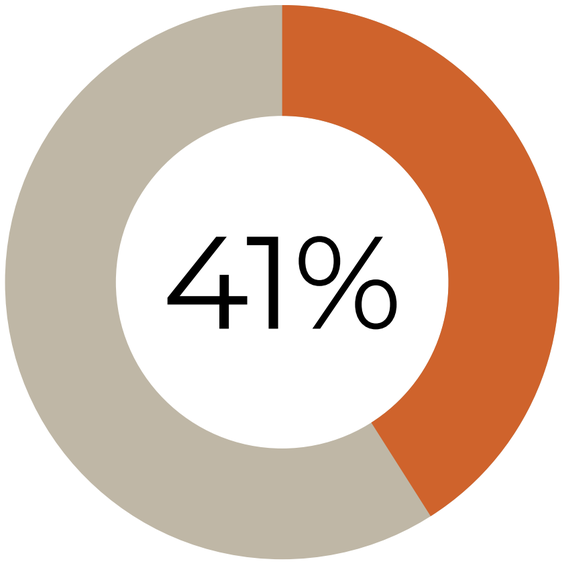
What nonprofits are asking for:

- Advocacy
- Capacity-building and technical assistance
- Assistance “beyond the grant”
- Coordinated, responsive funding

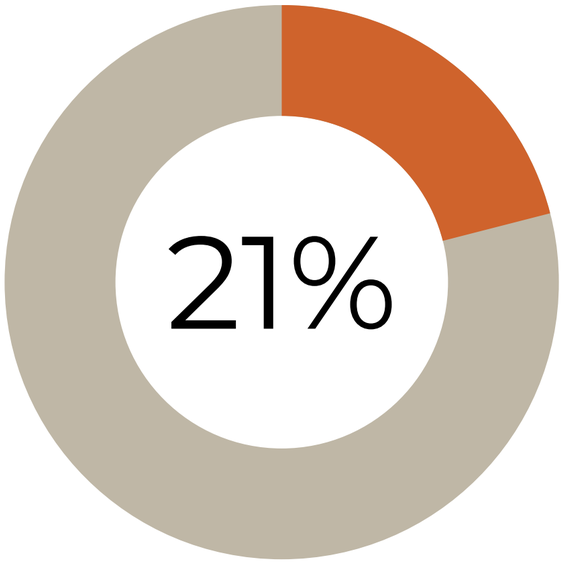
Most Valuable Supports: Advocacy



50% of nonprofit respondents said one of the most valuable supports to their organization would be **funders advocating for more stable and supportive policies**

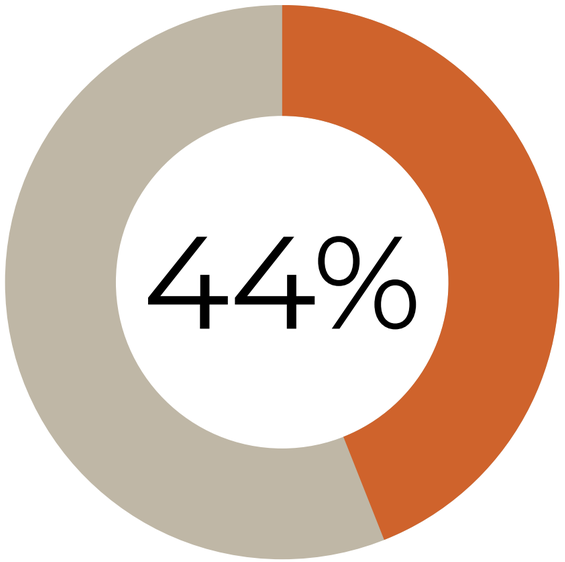


41% of nonprofit respondents said one of the most valuable supports to their organization would be **amplification of nonprofit voices on public platforms and influence**

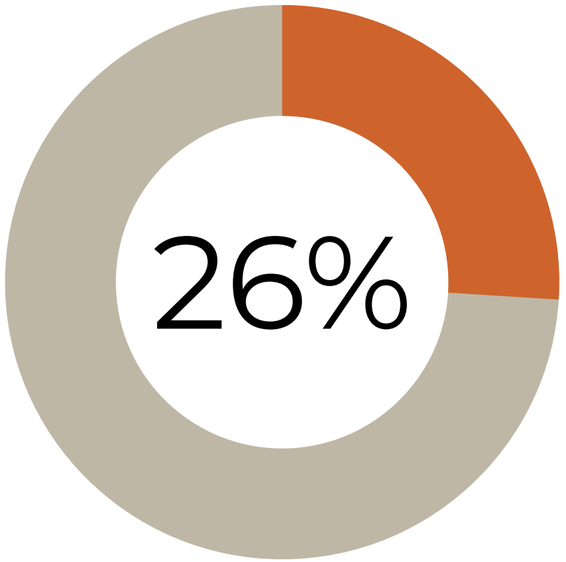


21% of nonprofit respondents said one of the most valuable supports to their organization would be **training on nonprofit advocacy and lobbying**

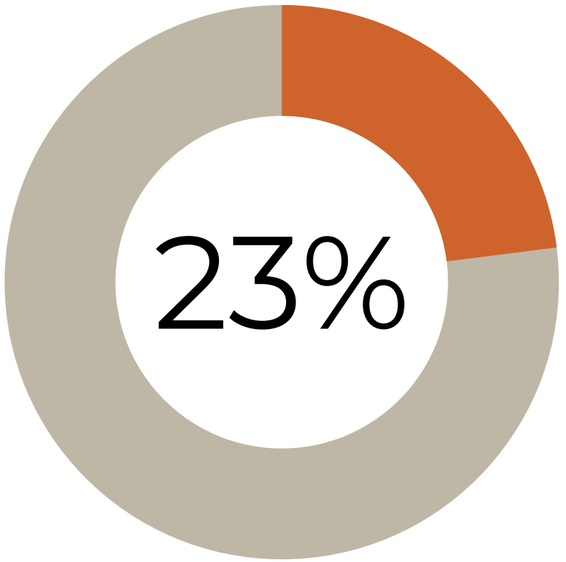
Most Valuable Supports: Capacity-Building and Technical Assistance



44% of nonprofit respondents said one of the most valuable supports to their organization would be **technical assistance and organizational capacity building**

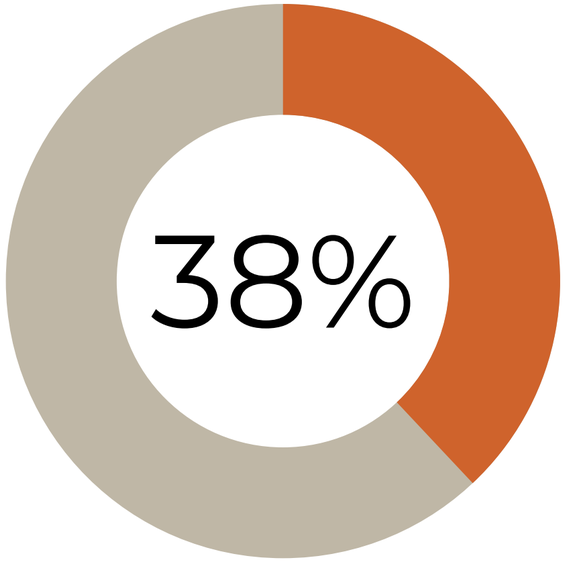


26% of nonprofit respondents said one of the most valuable supports to their organization would be **research and data insights to support decision-making**

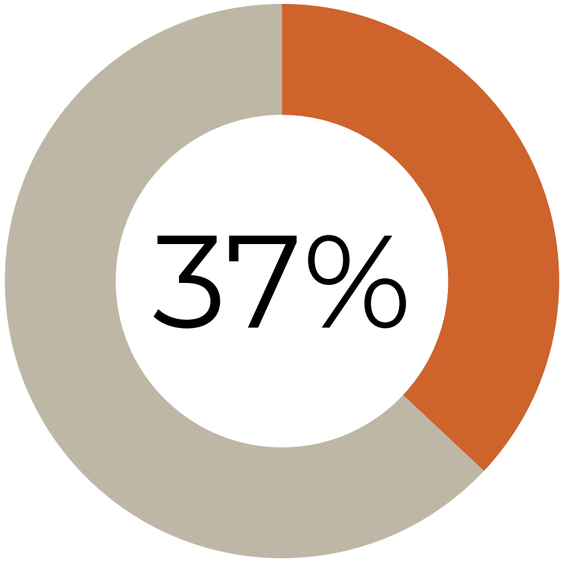


23% of nonprofit respondents said one of the most valuable supports to their organization would be **support for structure changes (strategic partnerships, mergers, acquisitions, dissolutions)**

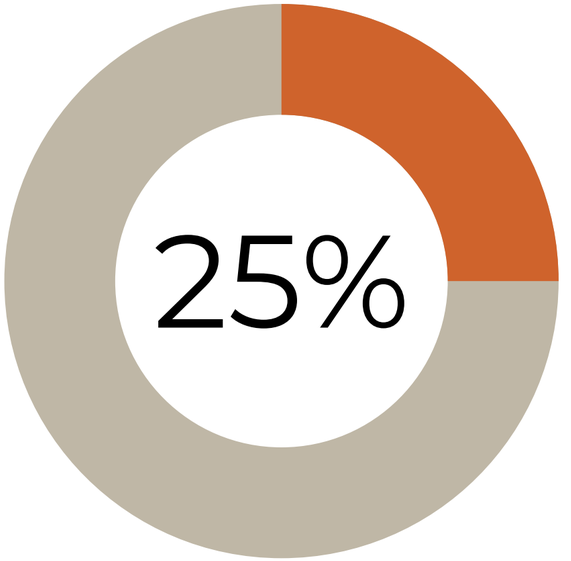
Most Valuable Supports: Assistance Beyond the Grant



38% of nonprofit respondents said one of the most valuable supports to their organization would be **support for staff well-being**



37% of nonprofit respondents said one of the most valuable supports to their organization would be **leadership development for them and their team**



25% of nonprofit respondents said one of the most valuable supports to their organization would be **support for boards on navigating changes**

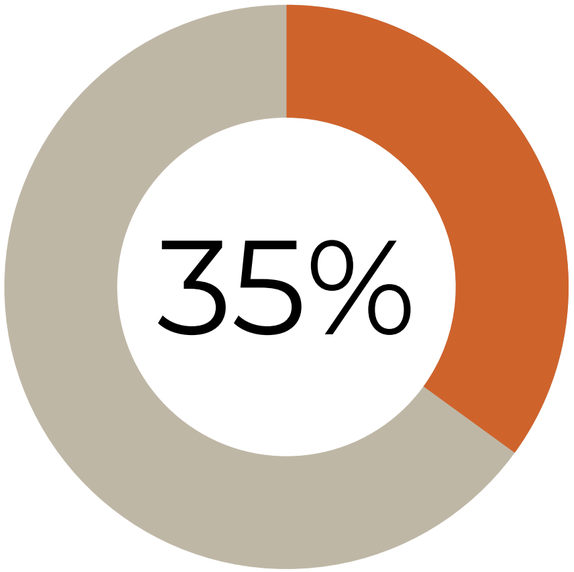
Most Valuable Supports: Assistance Beyond the Grant

> There is a great deal of mental exhaustion, burnout, and general stress resulting from the current state and general uncertainty of things. I think we are going to see even more burnout and leadership turnover than we have in past years, which could be especially detrimental to the health of many organizations given the state of fundraising and philanthropy.

> There needs to be a local source for board training.

> I really appreciate the foundation recognizing the need for support for staff well-being and being offered as an option. This is key to our organization!

Most Valuable Supports: Collaborative, Responsive Funding



35% of nonprofit respondents said one of the most valuable supports to their organization would be **rapid response funding**

> In 2024 the time it took to receive notice from funders increased a great deal which can make cash flow a concern

> Where there is a relationship established, donors should trust that the nonprofit will effectively allocate unrestricted funds to have the greatest impact - in this everchanging and volatile environment, spending flexibility is imperative for nonprofit leaders.

A Couple of Final Thoughts From our Nonprofits

> Please continue to learn and listen to nonprofit needs. There is a shift in the sector with many new leaders/staff who need support and professional training to serve their mission. There is also new generation of board members entering the space who need training on their role so they understand exactly their role compared to the ED/CEO, and staff, etc. This is critical to ensure [nonprofits] are operating more efficiently and not unintentionally creating inefficiencies due to not being professionally trained on their role.

A Couple of Final Thoughts From our Nonprofits

> Hard challenges don't need to equate to hard days/weeks/years. We can address these with a culture of competence and willingness ...

Next Steps

Additional listening & action sessions to come in early 2026!

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